

How to Teach One-on-One ESL Lessons

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Date: May 2026

REFLECTION

The article gave me quite an interesting overview of how one-to-one teaching differs from teaching groups. What surprised me the most was probably the distinction between instruction and tutoring. Before reading it, I honestly never really thought about these as two different categories, but after the explanation the difference in the teacher's role became much clearer to me. In tutoring, the teacher feels less like someone who controls the lesson and more like a facilitator or guide, which actually reminded me of the thinking classroom approach we discussed during peer observation.

I also found interesting the point about writing exercises. The article suggested that activities students could easily do alone at home may not be the best use of lesson time in one-to-one teaching, because interaction there becomes much more valuable. And honestly, this makes sense to me. In individual lessons every minute feels more "visible," so task design probably has to be much more intentional than in group classes.

At the same time, I am not fully sure whether all of the advice from the article would work equally well for every age group or language level. While reading it, I had the feeling that it was written mainly with teenagers or adults in mind. I imagine that one-to-one teaching with VYLs or beginner learners would probably look much more dynamic, visual, and play-oriented.

Another thing I was thinking about while reading the article is that one-to-one teaching can sometimes create a lot of pressure not only for the teacher but also for the student. In group lessons, students can hide a little, observe others, or take small breaks during pair and group work. In one-to-one lessons, the attention is constant almost all the time, which could become mentally exhausting, especially for introverted or anxious learners. The article mostly focused on efficiency and personalization, but I think the emotional side of constant interaction is also important to consider. Sometimes group energy and interaction between students can actually reduce stress and make learning feel more natural.